

Dagger
Legionaries carried a dagger *(pugio)*, worn at the left hip, as well as a sword. A few were richly decorated with bronze handles. The grooves and ridges gave added strength to the blade.

Pilum
Before charging the enemy, legionaries normally unleashed a terrifying volley of javelins *(pila)*. About 2m (over 6ft) long, the *pilum* was tipped with a heavy iron shank ending in a pyramidal spearhead. At short range, it was capable of penetrating shields and armour. A spike at the butt end enabled soldiers to stand their javelins in the ground.

Shield
The curved rectangular shield with slightly rounded corners evolved in the 1st century CE. The iron boss *(umbo)* in the centre served as an offensive weapon enabling legionaries to batter their way through their enemies' ranks.